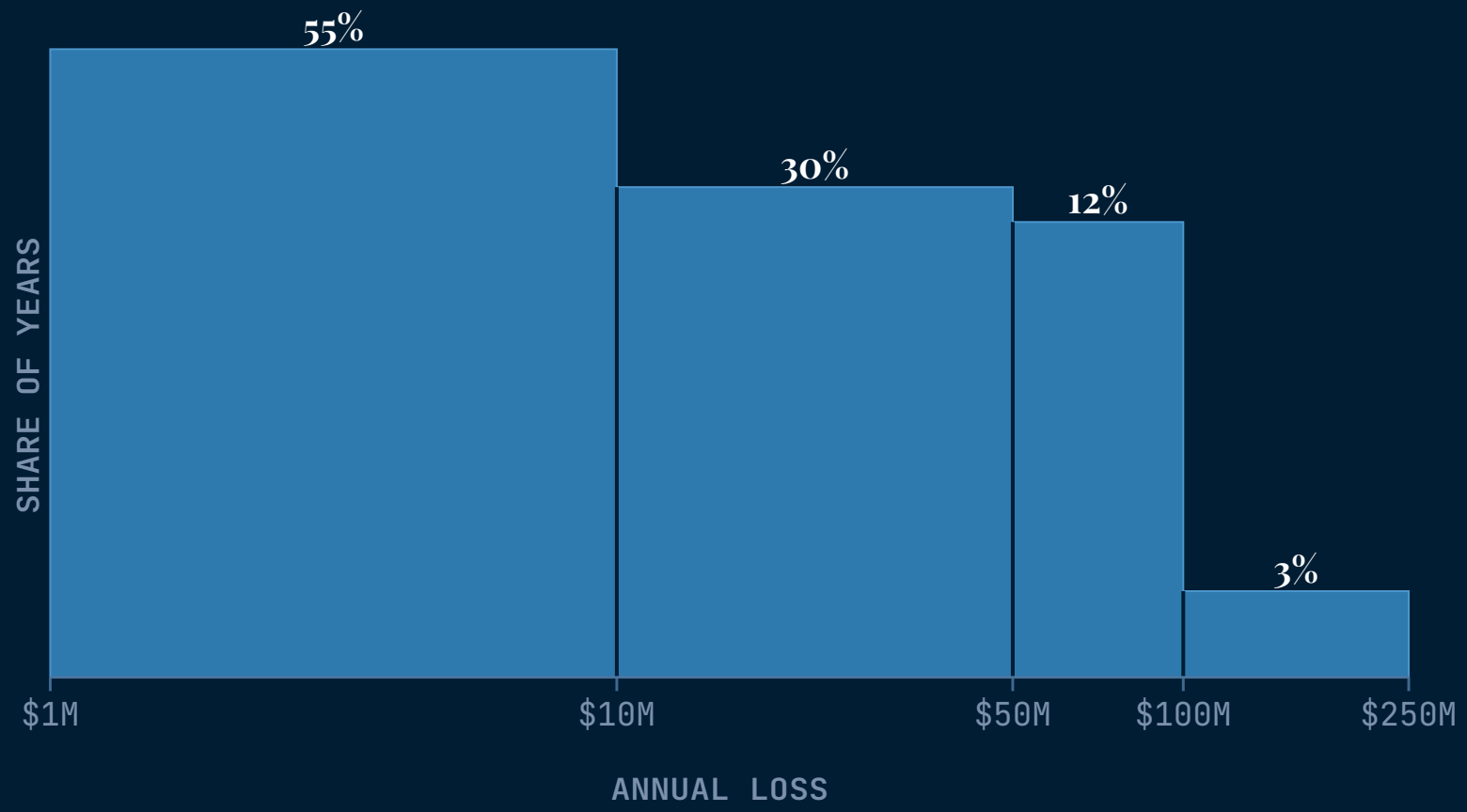
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# histogram

One quantity cut into bands that join end to end: each bar is as wide as its band and its area is the band's share, with an optional log axis for bands that widen toward the tail.

# Most years stay under $10M; one in thirty tops $100M.



# Twelve bands, a long thin tail.




Stress test · histogram — Twelve equal bands on a linear axis, the tail bands under one percent.

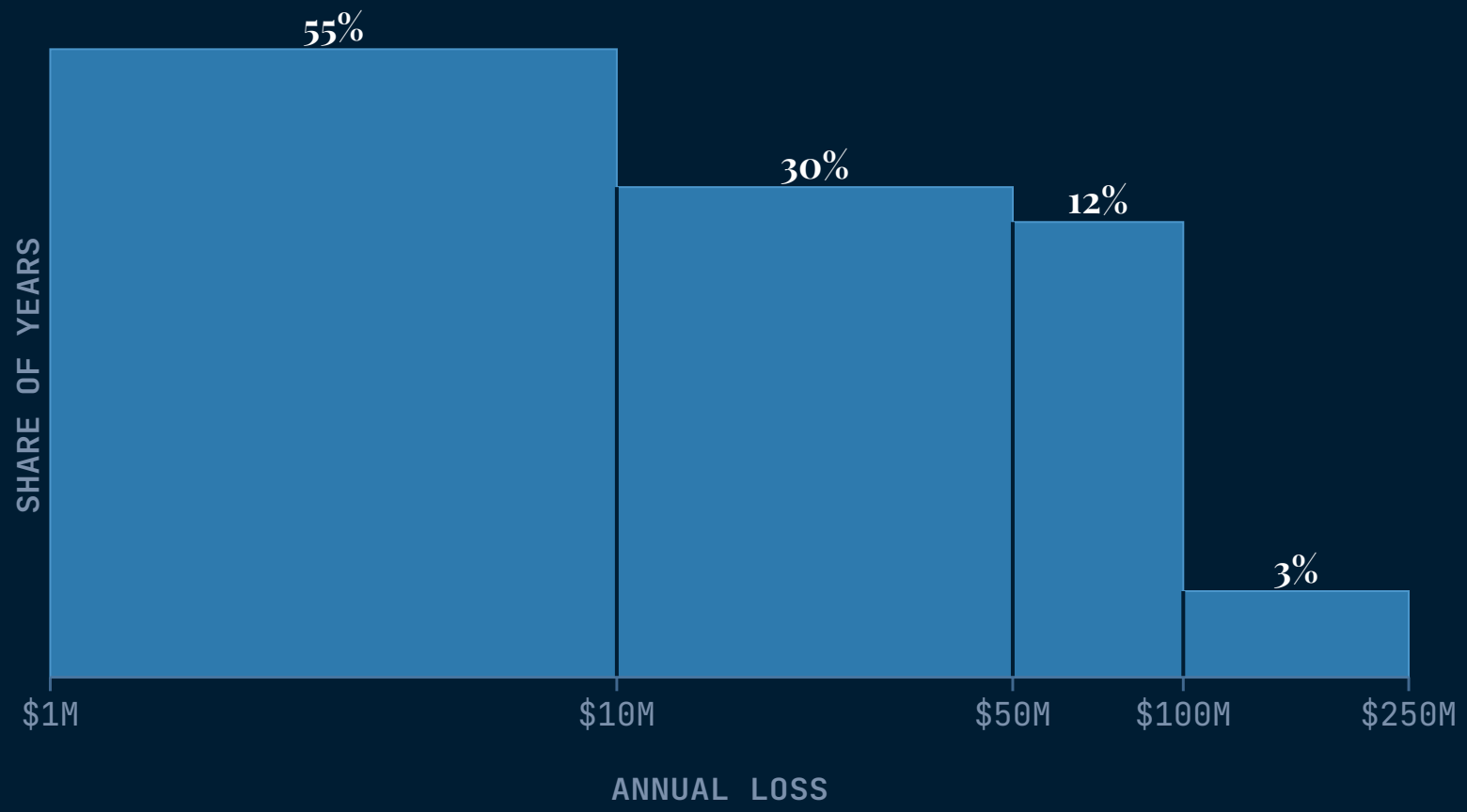
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# When NOT to reach for histogram.

### Categories that are not a number line

Regions, products or lines of business are separate things, not bands of one quantity. Use `bar`, which leaves gaps between them.

### A dash for a range

`$1M-$10M` is not a band: the dash reads two ways beside a negative number. Write `$1M..$10M`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`bar` — separate categories compared by size, not bands of one quantity

`ep-curve` — the chance of a loss above each amount, read as a return period

`line` — one quantity over time